

Christianity Without Christ

*What the faith looks like without accountability, without community,
and without the identity of Jesus at the forefront
Each Old Testament statement is followed by its matching New Testament statement*

Christianity without Christ is not atheism. It is a religion that still uses His vocabulary while refusing His rule. It keeps a cross as jewelry, a Bible as décor, and a church as a brand. It will talk about love while silencing correction. It will talk about freedom while isolating the soul. It will talk about God while leaving Jesus unnamed, unlabeled, and optional.

This study answers one question in three parts: **What does Christianity look like without accountability, without community, and without the identity of Jesus at the forefront?** Each pairing is one Old Testament statement, then the New Testament statement that answers it. The covenant did not invent these three later. Israel already knew them. The church is not allowed to unlearn them.

This is a warrant list, not a claim that every verse is only about modern church culture. Each pairing is here because it names the same pattern: a people who still say they belong to God, while they refuse His measuring, His assembly, or His Name.

I. Without Accountability

Accountability is not a Western small-group invention. It is God's measuring of a people who claim His Name. Without it, Christianity becomes a private brand: no confession, no correction, no fruit that can be tested, no elder who may speak, no consequence that may land. The Old Testament already called that a people who "do what is right in their own eyes." The New Testament calls it a house that will not judge itself, and so is judged.

OLD TESTAMENT Judges 17:6; 21:25. In those days there was no king in Israel; every man did what was right in his own eyes. Religion without a measuring rod looks busy and is lawless.

NEW TESTAMENT Matthew 7:21–23. Not everyone who says "Lord, Lord" enters. Many prophesy and cast out demons in His name, and He still says, "I never knew you." Words without being known are not discipleship.

OLD TESTAMENT Proverbs 28:13. He who conceals his transgressions will not prosper, but he who confesses and forsakes them will find compassion.

NEW TESTAMENT 1 John 1:8–10. If we say we have no sin, we deceive ourselves. If we confess, He is faithful to forgive. Unaccountable Christianity starts by calling darkness light.

OLD TESTAMENT Leviticus 19:17. You shall not hate your brother in your heart; you shall surely reprove your neighbor, and not incur sin because of him.

NEW TESTAMENT Matthew 18:15–17. If your brother sins, go to him; then two or three; then the church. Silence that protects sin is not love. It is shared guilt.

OLD TESTAMENT Ezekiel 33:7–9. The watchman who sees the sword and does not blow the trumpet: the wicked dies in his iniquity, and his blood is required at the watchman's hand.

NEW TESTAMENT Acts 20:26–31; Hebrews 13:17. Paul is innocent of blood because he did not shrink from declaring the whole counsel. Leaders watch for souls as those who will give an account.

OLD TESTAMENT 2 Samuel 12:7–13. Nathan says to David, "You are the man." The king is not above the word. Confession follows exposure.

NEW TESTAMENT Galatians 2:11–14. Paul opposes Peter to his face because he stood condemned. Apostolic rank does not cancel public sin. The gospel is the standard, not the celebrity.

OLD TESTAMENT Psalm 141:5. Let the righteous smite me in kindness and reprove me; it is oil upon the head. Do not refuse it.

NEW TESTAMENT Hebrews 12:5–11. Whom the Lord loves He disciplines. A Christianity that cannot be chastened is illegitimate, not mature.

OLD TESTAMENT Deuteronomy 13:1–5; 18:20–22. A prophet who signs wonders but leads away from the LORD is to be refused. Signs are not the test. Loyalty to God is.

NEW TESTAMENT 1 John 4:1; 2 Peter 2:1–3. Test the spirits. False teachers secretly introduce destructive heresies, even denying the Master who bought them. Charisma without confession of Jesus is a trap.

OLD TESTAMENT Isaiah 5:20. Woe to those who call evil good and good evil, who put darkness for light.

NEW TESTAMENT Ephesians 5:11–13. Do not participate in the unfruitful deeds of darkness, but rather expose them. A church that will not name darkness is already partnered with it.

OLD TESTAMENT Amos 5:21–24. God hates feast days when justice is withheld. Worship without righteousness is noise He will not receive.

NEW TESTAMENT James 1:22–27; 2:14–17. Hearers only deceive themselves. Faith without works is dead. Orphan-care and an unstained tongue are religion God owns; a service hour is not.

OLD TESTAMENT Malachi 1:6–10. “If I am a father, where is My honor?” Polluted offerings, bored priests, a table they despise — and they still ask, “How have we despised Your name?”

NEW TESTAMENT 1 Corinthians 11:27–32. Whoever eats and drinks unworthily eats judgment. If we judged ourselves, we would not be judged. The table itself is an accountability.

OLD TESTAMENT Jeremiah 6:14; 8:11. They have healed the wound of My people slightly, saying, “Peace, peace,” when there is no peace.

NEW TESTAMENT 2 Timothy 4:3–4. They will not endure sound doctrine; they accumulate teachers to tickle the ear. Unaccountable Christianity hires a chaplain for its preferences.

OLD TESTAMENT Numbers 32:23. Be sure your sin will find you out.

NEW TESTAMENT Luke 12:2–3; 1 Timothy 5:24–25. Nothing covered that will not be revealed. Some sins are evident now; some follow later. Delay is not acquittal.

OLD TESTAMENT Proverbs 27:17. Iron sharpens iron, so one man sharpens another.

NEW TESTAMENT Hebrews 3:12–13. Take care lest there be in any of you an evil, unbelieving heart. Encourage one another day after day, lest any be hardened by the deceitfulness of sin. Isolation is how hardness wins.

OLD TESTAMENT Exodus 18:21–22. Able men who fear God, who hate dishonest gain, judge the small matters. Authority is not celebrity; it is fear of God applied to cases.

NEW TESTAMENT 1 Corinthians 5:1–13; 6:1–5. The church must judge those inside. Remove the wicked man. Saints will judge the world — and they will not even judge a trivial case? Unaccountable “grace” is a refusal to be a people.

Without accountability, Christianity looks like: secret sin with public worship; prophets who cannot be tested; shepherds who will not bleed for the flock by speaking; a table no one examines himself for; and a gospel that never says “you are the man.”

II. Without Community

The Bible does not know a saved individual who is not also placed in a people. God called a nation, a remnant, a body, a household, a flock. Christianity without community is a soul that wants Jesus as personal accessory and the church as optional content. It keeps the language of “my walk” and drops the language of “one another.”

OLD TESTAMENT Genesis 2:18. It is not good for the man to be alone. Isolation was named a problem before the fall. The image of God was male and female in a shared task, not a private spirituality.

NEW TESTAMENT 1 Corinthians 12:12–27. The body is one and has many members. The eye cannot say to the hand, “I have no need of you.” Lone Christianity is a dismembered claim.

OLD TESTAMENT Exodus 19:5–6. If you will obey My voice and keep My covenant, you shall be My own possession, a kingdom of priests and a holy nation. Covenant is corporate from the mountain.

NEW TESTAMENT 1 Peter 2:9–10. You are a chosen race, a royal priesthood, a holy nation, a people for God’s own possession. The church inherits the corporate titles, not a private brand.

OLD TESTAMENT Leviticus 19:18. You shall love your neighbor as yourself. The second great command assumes a neighbor, not a hermitage of the heart.

NEW TESTAMENT John 13:34–35. Love one another as I have loved you. By this all men will know you are My disciples. Christianity without community has no public credential Jesus named.

OLD TESTAMENT Psalm 133:1. How good and how pleasant it is for brothers to dwell together in unity.

NEW TESTAMENT Ephesians 4:1–6, 15–16. One body, one Spirit, one hope, one Lord, one faith, one baptism, one God. The body builds itself up in love as each joint supplies. Detached joints do not grow.

OLD TESTAMENT Isaiah 58:6–7. The fast God chooses includes loosing bonds, sharing bread with the hungry, bringing the homeless poor into the house, covering the naked, and not hiding from your own flesh.

NEW TESTAMENT Acts 2:42–47; 4:32–35. They devoted themselves to the apostles’ teaching, fellowship, breaking of bread, and prayers. They had all things in common. Christianity without community keeps the songs and drops the sharing.

OLD TESTAMENT Ecclesiastes 4:9–12. Two are better than one. If one falls, the other lifts him. A cord of three strands is not quickly torn apart.

NEW TESTAMENT Galatians 6:1–2. Restore the one caught in a trespass. Bear one another’s burdens, and so fulfill the law of Christ. A Christianity that will not carry cannot claim His law.

OLD TESTAMENT Deuteronomy 31:12–13. Assemble the people — men, women, children, sojourner — that they may hear and learn to fear the LORD. Gathering is how the next generation learns fear.

NEW TESTAMENT Hebrews 10:24–25. Consider how to stir one another up to love and good works, not forsaking our own assembling together, as is the habit of some. Isolation is named a habit, not a gifting.

OLD TESTAMENT Psalm 122:1. I was glad when they said to me, “Let us go to the house of the LORD.”

NEW TESTAMENT Colossians 3:16. Let the word of Christ dwell in you richly, teaching and admonishing one another with psalms, hymns, and spiritual songs. The house is a people who address one another with the word, not a stream you consume alone.

OLD TESTAMENT Proverbs 18:1. He who separates himself seeks his own desire; he quarrels against all sound wisdom.

NEW TESTAMENT Jude 19; 3 John 9–10. These are the ones who cause divisions, worldly-minded, devoid of the Spirit. Diotrephes loves to be first and refuses the brothers. Isolation and domination are two faces of the same refusal of the body.

OLD TESTAMENT Zechariah 8:16–17. Speak truth to one another; judge with truth in your gates; do not love a false oath. Community is a gate where truth is spoken, not a club where feelings rule.

NEW TESTAMENT Ephesians 4:25. Laying aside falsehood, speak truth each one of you with his neighbor, for we are members of one another. Membership is the reason honesty is owed.

OLD TESTAMENT Ruth 1:16–17. Your people shall be my people, and your God my God. Belonging to God included belonging to a people, even when it cost Moab’s old identity.

NEW TESTAMENT Romans 12:4–5, 10, 13, 15–16. We who are many are one body in Christ, and individually members one of another. Be devoted. Contribute to the saints. Weep with those who weep. Christianity without community wants God without a people.

OLD TESTAMENT Nehemiah 8:1–8. All the people gathered as one man, and Ezra read the Law. Understanding was public. The book was not a private oracle.

NEW TESTAMENT 1 Timothy 4:13; 2 Timothy 4:2. Give attention to public reading, exhortation, teaching. Preach the word in season and out. A Bible no one hears together is already being edited by the self.

Without community, Christianity looks like: a feed instead of a flock; a podcast instead of a table; a private Jesus who never has to share you with a difficult saint; and a faith that cannot restore, cannot bear, and cannot be seen.

III. Without the Identity of Jesus at the Forefront

This is the center. Accountability and community can still be counterfeited by a club. What cannot be counterfeited for long is whether Jesus is named as Lord, Son, Lamb, and the only Name under heaven. A Christianity that foregrounds values, vibes, nation, self-help, angels, Mary, apostles, miracles, or “God” as a blur — while Jesus is a mascot — is already another religion wearing leftover vocabulary.

OLD TESTAMENT Exodus 20:3; Deuteronomy 6:4–5. You shall have no other gods before Me. Hear, O Israel: the LORD is one. You shall love Him with all heart, soul, and might. First-commandment faith has a Name at the front, not a feeling.

NEW TESTAMENT Matthew 22:37; Philippians 2:9–11. The same command, then the Name above every name: Jesus. Every knee bows, every tongue confesses that Jesus Christ is Lord, to the glory of God the Father. God at the forefront means Jesus confessed as Lord, not “spirituality.”

OLD TESTAMENT Psalm 2:1–12. The nations rage against the LORD and against His Anointed. Kiss the Son, lest He be angry. Messiah is not optional in the Old Testament’s own kingship psalm.

NEW TESTAMENT Acts 4:11–12; 13:32–33. Jesus is the stone the builders rejected. There is salvation in no one else; there is no other name under heaven given among men by which we must be saved. Psalm 2 is preached as raised Jesus.

OLD TESTAMENT Isaiah 42:8. I am the LORD, that is My name; I will not give My glory to another, nor My praise to graven images.

NEW TESTAMENT John 17:1–5; Hebrews 1:3. The Father glorifies the Son; the Son is the radiance of His glory and the exact representation of His nature. A Christianity that will not put Jesus in front is already giving glory to another.

OLD TESTAMENT Isaiah 53:3–6, 11. He was despised, pierced for our transgressions; the LORD has caused the iniquity of us all to fall on Him. The Servant is the sin-bearer, not a moral example only.

NEW TESTAMENT 1 Peter 2:24; 1 Corinthians 15:3–4. He Himself bore our sins in His body on the tree. Christ died for our sins according to the Scriptures, was buried, and was raised. If that is not the forefront, the rest is a lecture.

OLD TESTAMENT Jeremiah 9:23–24. Let not the wise, mighty, or rich boast. Let him who boasts boast that he understands and knows Me, that I am the LORD who exercises lovingkindness, justice, and righteousness.

NEW TESTAMENT 1 Corinthians 2:2; Galatians 6:14. I determined to know nothing among you except Jesus Christ, and Him crucified. May I never boast except in the cross of our Lord Jesus Christ. Knowledge of God without the crucified Christ is the boast Jeremiah forbids, relocated.

OLD TESTAMENT Isaiah 45:22–23. Turn to Me and be saved, all the ends of the earth. I have sworn: every knee will bow, every tongue will swear allegiance.

NEW TESTAMENT Romans 14:11; Philippians 2:10–11. Isaiah's oath is applied to Jesus. The nations do not get a generic deity at the end. They get the Name.

OLD TESTAMENT Joel 2:32. Whoever calls on the name of the LORD will be delivered.

NEW TESTAMENT Romans 10:9–13. If you confess with your mouth Jesus as Lord, and believe God raised Him, you will be saved. "Whoever calls on the name of the Lord" is the Name of Jesus. Forefront is confession, not mood.

OLD TESTAMENT Micah 5:2. From Bethlehem One will go forth for Me to be ruler in Israel; His goings forth are from long ago, from the days of eternity.

NEW TESTAMENT Matthew 2:5–6; John 1:1, 14. The eternal Word became flesh and dwelt among us. A Christianity that will not start with who He is will end by using Him as illustration.

OLD TESTAMENT Zechariah 12:10. They will look on Me whom they have pierced, and they will mourn for Him.

NEW TESTAMENT John 19:37; Revelation 1:7. The pierced One is Jesus. Every eye will see Him. A faith that will not look on the Pierced One now is not practicing for that day.

OLD TESTAMENT Numbers 21:8–9. The bronze serpent lifted up: look and live. The remedy is not self-improvement; it is looking at God's appointed sign.

NEW TESTAMENT John 3:14–18. As Moses lifted up the serpent, so must the Son of Man be lifted up. Whoever believes in Him is not judged. Christianity without Christ lifted up offers programs instead of looking.

OLD TESTAMENT Psalm 118:22–26. The stone the builders rejected has become the chief cornerstone. Blessed is He who comes in the name of the LORD.

NEW TESTAMENT Matthew 21:42; Ephesians 2:20; 1 Peter 2:4–8. Jesus is the cornerstone. Built on apostles and prophets, Christ Jesus Himself being the cornerstone. Remove Him from the front and the building is a pile.

OLD TESTAMENT Hosea 4:6; 6:6. My people are destroyed for lack of knowledge. I desire loyalty, not sacrifice; the knowledge of God rather than burnt offerings.

NEW TESTAMENT John 17:3; Colossians 1:15–20. This is eternal life: that they may know You, the only true God, and Jesus Christ whom You have sent. He is the image of the invisible God, firstborn, the One in whom all things hold together, the Head of the body. Knowledge of God is knowledge of this Son, or it is not the knowledge Hosea meant.

OLD TESTAMENT Isaiah 9:6–7. A child is born, a son is given; the government will rest on His shoulders. Wonderful Counselor, Mighty God, Eternal Father, Prince of Peace. The throne of David is His.

NEW TESTAMENT Luke 1:32–33; Revelation 19:16. He will be great and will be called the Son of the Most High; He will reign over the house of Jacob forever. On His robe: King of kings and Lord of lords. A Christianity that keeps Jesus as mascot and puts government, therapy, or tribe on the shoulders is already in Isaiah's opposite.

OLD TESTAMENT Deuteronomy 18:15–19. The LORD will raise up a Prophet like Moses; whoever will not listen to Him, God will require it of him.

NEW TESTAMENT Acts 3:22–23; Hebrews 1:1–2. God has spoken in His Son. Moses' Prophet is Jesus. Christianity without Christ at the forefront still "listens" — to influencers, wounds, markets, and spirits — and thinks that is hearing God.

Without Jesus at the forefront, Christianity looks like: God-talk with a blank face; crucifixion as metaphor; resurrection as optional poetry; a cornerstone replaced by personality, politics, or pain; and a Name no knee is actually asked to bow to.

IV. The Three Together — What the Counterfeit Looks Like

Scripture often stacks the three failures in one people: they will not be measured, they will not stay a people, and they will not keep the Name holy. That is Christianity without Christ in a single picture.

OLD TESTAMENT Isaiah 1:11–17. Multitude of sacrifices, appointed feasts — and God is weary. Cease to do evil; learn to do good; seek justice. Worship without accountability and without the oppressed neighbor is a noise festival.

NEW TESTAMENT Revelation 2:1–5; 3:1, 15–17. Ephesus works hard and cannot bear evil men, yet left the first love. Sardis has a name that they are alive, and are dead. Laodicea is lukewarm, rich in its own eyes, and cannot see it needs Him. Churches can keep structure and lose Jesus.

OLD TESTAMENT Jeremiah 7:4, 8–11. “The temple of the LORD, the temple of the LORD.” They steal, murder, commit adultery, swear falsely, burn incense to Baal, then stand in the house and say, “We are delivered.” A den of robbers with liturgy.

NEW TESTAMENT Matthew 21:12–13; 23:27–28. Jesus cites Jeremiah in the temple. Woe to whitewashed tombs: outwardly beautiful, inwardly full of dead men’s bones. Brand Christianity is a tomb with a logo.

OLD TESTAMENT Ezekiel 34:1–6. Shepherds feed themselves. The weak are not strengthened, the sick not healed, the scattered not sought. The flock is food.

NEW TESTAMENT John 10:11–13; 1 Peter 5:2–4. The Good Shepherd lays down His life. Hirelings flee. Elders shepherd not for sordid gain, nor lording it over the flock. Without Jesus as Shepherd, community becomes a platform and accountability becomes a brand-protection policy.

OLD TESTAMENT Malachi 3:1–5, 8–18. The Lord whom you seek will come to His temple as a refiner. He will be a witness against sorcerers, adulterers, those who swear falsely, who oppress the wage-earner, widow, and orphan. Some say it is vain to serve God.

NEW TESTAMENT Matthew 3:11–12; 25:31–46. He baptizes with the Holy Spirit and fire; He winnows. The King separates sheep and goats by whether they did it to the least of these, His brothers. Forefront Jesus still measures the people and still identifies with the least.

OLD TESTAMENT Psalm 50:16–21. To the wicked God says: what right have you to recite My statutes and take My covenant in your mouth? You hate discipline. You slander your brother. You thought I was just like you.

NEW TESTAMENT Titus 1:16; 2 Timothy 3:5. They profess to know God, but by their deeds they deny Him. Holding to a form of godliness, they have denied its power. Avoid such men. Christianity without Christ is a mouth full of covenant and a life that has voted God off the throne.

V. The Contrast — Christianity With Christ

The opposite is not harsher religion. It is Jesus in front, a people around Him, and a life that can be examined. The same two Testaments that diagnose the counterfeit already describe the

real thing.

OLD TESTAMENT Micah 6:8. He has told you what is good: do justice, love kindness, walk humbly with your God.

NEW TESTAMENT Matthew 23:23; James 1:27. Justice, mercy, and faithfulness are the weightier matters. Pure religion visits orphans and widows and keeps unstained from the world. Walk with God is still walk with the people He loves.

OLD TESTAMENT 2 Chronicles 7:14. If My people who are called by My name will humble themselves, pray, seek My face, and turn from their wicked ways, I will hear, forgive, and heal their land.

NEW TESTAMENT Acts 2:36–42. God has made this Jesus both Lord and Christ. They were pierced, they asked what to do, they repented, were baptized in His name, and they devoted themselves to teaching, fellowship, bread, and prayers. Name, repentance, and a people in one day.

OLD TESTAMENT Isaiah 55:6–7. Seek the LORD while He may be found. Let the wicked forsake his way. He will abundantly pardon.

NEW TESTAMENT Luke 24:46–47; 1 John 2:1–6. Repentance for forgiveness of sins is to be proclaimed in His name to all nations. If we say we know Him and do not keep His commandments, we are liars. Pardon is not permission to walk without Him.

OLD TESTAMENT Jeremiah 31:31–34. A new covenant: law written on the heart; they shall all know Me; I will forgive their iniquity.

NEW TESTAMENT Luke 22:20; Hebrews 8:6–13; 10:19–25. This cup is the new covenant in My blood. Draw near, hold fast, consider one another, do not forsake assembling. The new covenant produces a people who know Him, not a crowd that names Him and stays unaccountable.

What does Christianity look like without those three?

- **Without accountability:** “Lord, Lord” with concealed sin; peace, peace when there is none; a table no one examines; prophets who cannot be tested; a watchman who will not blow the trumpet. Old Testament: Judges 21:25, Proverbs 28:13, Ezekiel 33. New Testament: Matthew 7:21–23, 1 John 1, 1 Corinthians 5 and 11.
- **Without community:** a member who says “I have no need of you”; assembling forsaken as a habit; burdens unborne; love unshown, so the world has no credential Jesus named. Old Testament: Exodus 19, Psalm 133, Ecclesiastes 4. New Testament: 1 Corinthians 12, Hebrews 10:24–25, John 13:34–35.

- **Without Jesus at the forefront:** another glory, another boast, another name, a cornerstone pulled out, a serpent no one will look at. Old Testament: Psalm 2, Isaiah 42:8 and 53, Joel 2:32. New Testament: Acts 4:12, 1 Corinthians 2:2, Philippians 2:9–11, Colossians 1:15–20.
- **The three stacked:** temple talk in a den of robbers; a name that they live, and they are dead; a form of godliness that denies the power. That is Christianity without Christ.

Christianity with Christ is not a mood. It is a Name confessed, a people assembled, and a life that can be reproved. The Testaments agree because they are one God speaking. He will not share His glory, and He will not let His Son be a mascot for an unexamined, ungathered religion.

Christianity Without Christ. Old Testament statement, then matching New Testament statement, on faith without accountability, without community, and without Jesus at the forefront. Scripture in English sense from the common evangelical text tradition (NASB-style). Not a substitute for reading the passages in full.

Living Word Map — map.repentance101.com